Professional Project Narratives

0 MAIN SECTIONS • PRINT-READY EDITION

Evidence sheet: fill this in for each story

Field	Your notes
Project and dates	
Business problem and affected users	
My exact responsibility and code ownership	
Request/data flow in 5-7 steps	
Technologies and versions I can verify	
Hardest technical decision and alternative	
One failure scenario and recovery	
Tests and rollout checks	
Metric: baseline, result, period and measurement	
What I would improve now	

If you cannot verify a metric, say: "I don't recall the exact baseline, so I don't want to overstate the percentage. The improvement we observed was [accurate description]."

1. Commercial User Management — REST APIs, Java, Vert.x, and Redis

"One relevant project was our Commercial User Management platform at American Express. My responsibility included designing and developing RESTful services using Java and Vert.x and integrating them with our React/Redux frontend.

The main challenge was building a scalable self-service platform that allowed corporate clients to manage users, roles, and account information without relying heavily on manual support.

I contributed to backend API development, frontend integration, and role-management features. For frequently accessed data, we introduced Redis caching, which reduced response times by 35%, particularly during peak traffic.

The overall self-service platform also reduced client onboarding time by 30%.

This project gave me hands-on experience designing APIs, improving distributed application performance, and connecting technical decisions with customer outcomes."

2. Microservices Observability — Jaeger Distributed Tracing

"Another project involved improving observability for our Commercial User Management platform.

My responsibility included integrating Jaeger distributed tracing into our microservices environment.

The main challenge was troubleshooting issues across multiple services, where understanding the complete request flow was important for identifying performance problems.

We introduced distributed tracing to provide better visibility into service interactions and help engineers investigate failures more efficiently.

The implementation reduced debugging time by 40%.

This project strengthened my understanding of microservices observability and the importance of building operational visibility into distributed systems."

3. Commercial Reconciliation — Third-Party Platform Migration

"One of my recent projects involved migrating BTA-Connect clients from a third-party solution to an internally managed commercial reconciliation platform.

My responsibility included leading the MVP design and migration strategy, working closely with Product, Architecture, and engineering teams.

The main challenge was understanding the existing third-party capabilities, identifying essential features, and designing an enterprise-aligned solution that would reduce external dependencies.

I helped analyze the current platform, identify capability gaps, define the MVP scope, and guide architectural decisions for the in-house platform.

An important architectural consideration was balancing the initial MVP scope with the long-term product roadmap.

This project demonstrated my ability to connect business requirements, technical architecture, and platform modernization strategy."

4. Enterprise Identity and Access Management — IAM and MFA

"Another important initiative was implementing Identity and Access Management and multi-factor authentication across corporate payment and reconciliation applications.

My responsibility was leading the technical implementation and helping ensure alignment with enterprise security standards.

The main challenge was strengthening authentication and access controls across business-critical applications that handle sensitive payment information.

I worked with engineering teams to implement IAM and MFA capabilities and address security vulnerabilities based on OWASP practices.

We also focused on building scalable security capabilities that aligned with enterprise-wide requirements.

This experience strengthened my understanding of application security architecture, authentication, access management, and cross-platform integration."

5. Certificate Renewal Automation — Operational Resilience

"One project focused on automating message-signing certificate renewal for critical payment platforms.

The main challenge was that certificate maintenance required manual operational effort, and expired certificates could disrupt business-critical integrations.

I developed a certificate renewal automation tool to reduce dependency on manual processes and improve operational reliability.

The implementation reduced manual effort by 90% and achieved zero certificate-expiration incidents.

Beyond the efficiency improvement, this initiative helped strengthen operational compliance and continuity for payment services.

It reinforced the value of designing operational automation as part of an enterprise platform's reliability strategy."

6. Commercial Payments Modernization — File-Based to Real-Time Services

"One of the larger modernization initiatives I led involved our Commercial Payments platforms at American Express.

My responsibility included architecture, design, and development across four corporate payment products.

The main challenge was modernizing legacy file-based integrations that supported complex payment workflows and dependencies across enterprise systems.

I worked on replacing file-based interfaces with real-time services and collaborated with architecture and business teams to align integration decisions with broader platform modernization goals.

This transformation improved processing performance and contributed to approximately $500,000 in reported cost savings.

The key experience was working through cross-platform integration challenges while delivering modernization across business-critical payment applications."

7. Commercial Payments — Architecture Strategy and $2.35M Funding

"Another significant project involved defining a modernization strategy for our Commercial Payments applications.

My responsibility was partnering with the portfolio architect to develop a cross-platform architecture proposal and align the solution with business and technology priorities.

The challenge was identifying a modernization approach that could support long-term platform objectives while addressing existing application dependencies.

I contributed to architecture planning, technical design discussions, and stakeholder alignment across the payment portfolio.

The resulting architecture proposal supported a product-funded release strategy worth $2.35 million.

This project demonstrated how I approach solution architecture beyond individual services, considering enterprise roadmaps, cross-platform dependencies, and business investment decisions."

8. Payment Platform Reliability — Blue-Green, Canary, and Splunk

"One important initiative focused on improving release reliability and operational support for critical payment applications.

My responsibility included driving deployment modernization and improving how teams monitored production systems.

The main challenge was reducing disruption during application releases while improving our ability to detect and resolve production issues.

We introduced blue-green and canary deployment strategies to make releases more controlled and reduce production downtime.

These improvements reduced deployment-related downtime by 90%.

We also improved incident response through Splunk monitoring and anomaly detection, reducing Mean Time to Resolution by 40%.

This work demonstrated the connection between deployment architecture, observability, and operational resilience."

9. Enterprise Data Integration — Mercator to Informatica Migration

"Earlier in my career at Harbor Payments, I led a major enterprise data integration modernization initiative.

The project involved migrating legacy Mercator-based transformations to Informatica Complex Data Exchange and PowerCenter.

My responsibility included technical design, development, migration leadership, and coordination with distributed teams.

The main challenge was modernizing complex data transformation processes used in corporate invoicing and payment workflows.

I worked with data transformations involving ANSI X12 EDI, XML, and flat-file formats, along with Java programs and UNIX scripts supporting integration workflows.

The project represented an approximately $3 million enterprise migration effort.

It gave me extensive experience with enterprise data integration, legacy modernization, complex interfaces, and coordinating large technical migrations."

10. Enterprise SaaS Modernization — E-Invoicing and Purchase-to-Pay

"At Verian, I led technical delivery for an enterprise e-Invoicing and Purchase-to-Pay platform.

One of our major initiatives involved transforming an installer-based application into a cloud-hosted SaaS solution.

My responsibility included architecture and development leadership, coordinating globally distributed teams, and working with product stakeholders and clients.

The main challenge was evolving the existing product into a scalable SaaS offering while continuing to meet enterprise customer requirements.

I helped drive the cloud transformation, align technical requirements with the product roadmap, and establish Agile delivery practices.

The modernization supported broader customer adoption and new revenue opportunities.

This experience strengthened my understanding of enterprise SaaS architecture, product modernization, and technical delivery leadership."